BATTERY LIFE

With the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2, Samsung has increased the battery capacity from 590mAh on the original Galaxy Watch Ultra to 800mAh here. That is a huge jump, considering that the new watch is slimmer. Samsung claims up to 60 hours with the Always-On Display enabled and up to 80 hours with it switched off. And this is the kind of battery life that smartwatches should boast about in the first place. Because I have never really understood why we collectively accepted that charging a watch every single day was normal. And for this, I am calling out all the previous-gen Galaxy Watches, Apple Watches, and the Pixel Watches.

For a phone that I use constantly, which has a huge display and does a hundred different things, a one-day battery life is somewhat acceptable. But a watch is supposed to be something you put on and forget about. The moment you start taking it off every night because it needs charging, you lose one of the biggest advantages of wearing a smartwatch in the first place: health and sleep tracking. The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 gives you considerably more breathing room.

Your exact battery life will obviously depend on how you use it. GPS tracking, workouts, LTE connectivity, and brightness can all affect endurance. But just because I don't work out frequently doesn't mean I went easy on the watch. I had the Always-On Display on all the time, GPS enabled, internet connectivity on, notifications constantly coming in, and all the health tracking features running. So, the watch was being used pretty much the way Samsung intended it to be used. And despite all of that, I didn't have to charge the watch daily.

Samsung has also added faster charging for the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2. The company claims the watch can reach around 40 per cent in approximately 30 minutes. As for the full 0 to 100 charging time, it takes 100 minutes.







HEALTH AND FITNESS

The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 is more capable than I am likely to ever need it to be. It has GPS tracking, multiple satellite positioning systems, advanced heart-rate monitoring, sleep tracking, body composition measurements, and a long list of workout modes. It can automatically detect certain activities and offer a detailed breakdown of health and fitness data through Samsung Health.

If you want, you can even push the watch into the extreme-use category. The Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 carries 10ATM water resistance, IP69K protection and EN13319 certification, allowing for diving at depths of up to 40 metres.

Now, will I ever use it 40 metres underwater? Most likely, no. But, even if there was a 0.1 per cent chance and I wanted to, I could. And that is the point of the Ultra branding. Not everyone buying the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 will use every feature. In fact, I suspect most people won't. But if you are spending this kind of money on a smartwatch, there is something reassuring about knowing that it can handle more than your everyday life is likely to throw at it.

Of course, if you are serious about fitness, there is plenty here to explore. Samsung Health is packed with data, there are plenty of workouts to track, and the watch can go into far more detail than I personally ever need it to.

You don't need to be a marathon runner to get value from health tracking. I haven't become an athlete with the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2, but having sleep information, activity tracking, step counts, heart-rate data, and reminders to move does make me more conscious of how inactive I am.

For all the talk about diving, GPS navigation, workout tracking, and everything else the Galaxy Watch Ultra 2 can do, I think its biggest strength is that it is a really good smartwatch. I like being able to glance at notifications. I like controlling music from my wrist. Being able to quickly reply to messages, and having access to apps and Google services makes the watch feel like an extension of your phone.

– Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 1.52-inch Super AMOLED | Brightness: 5000 nits | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Storage: 64 GB | Memory: 2 GB | Battery: 800 mAh | Connectivity: Bluetooth 6.0, NFC, WiFi (2.4 and 5 GHz), Embedded SIM | Weight: 61.5 g

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